

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 764

By Doggett

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Clara Parker of Giles County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to specially recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to improving the quality of life for their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Clara Parker, who has devoted forty years of her life to the preservation and safeguarding of Giles County's historical records; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Parker co-founded the Giles County Archives in 1986 with her friend and colleague Elizabeth White, establishing one of Tennessee's pioneering rural archives and creating a lasting institution dedicated to preserving the history, records, and stories of Giles County for future generations; and

WHEREAS, through meticulous effort, Clara Parker preserved thousands of historical records by cleaning, cataloging, and organizing materials, while dedicating countless hours to assisting individuals with genealogical research and guiding families in the compilation of family history books that document personal stories and lineages; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Parker authored the *Giles County Cemetery Book*, a project requiring years of research and extensive travel throughout the county to personally visit and document each cemetery; she uncovered critical historical insights, including evidence that county records were hidden during the Civil War to protect them from destruction; and

WHEREAS, Clara Parker strengthened archival preservation by building enduring partnerships with local government, libraries, historical societies, and the Tennessee State Library and Archives, advocating for best practices and for the preservation of records on microfilm to ensure their long-term protection and accessibility; and

WHEREAS, together with Elizabeth White, Ms. Parker compiled significant historical works, including the *Flournoy Rivers Manuscript* and *The History of Pisgah*, both of which were placed in the Library of Congress, and she co-authored numerous published articles, including the long-running series *From the Third Floor*; and

WHEREAS, throughout her distinguished career, Clara Parker has fostered community engagement by mentoring volunteers and interns through programs such as the 1987 Summer Youth Program and partnerships with local colleges, assisting individuals as notable as Lord Hailsham of St. Marylebone in tracing ancestral roots to Giles County, and unearthing countless historical treasures; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Parker is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and she should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor Clara Parker for her forty years of dedicated service to the preservation of Giles County's history, commend her for her lasting contributions to the cultural heritage of the State of Tennessee, and extend to her our best wishes for success and happiness in all her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.